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Logic cell structure and integrated circuit with the logic cell structure

Abstract

A logic cell structure includes a first portion, a second portion and a third portion. The first portion, arranged to be a first layout of a first semiconductor element, is placed in a first cell row of a substrate area extending in a first direction. The second portion, arranged to be a second layout of a second semiconductor element, is placed in a second cell row of the substrate area. The third portion is arranged to be a third layout of an interconnecting path used for coupling the first semiconductor element and the second semiconductor element. The first, second and third portions are bounded by a bounding box with a height in a second direction and a width in the first direction. Respective centers of the first portion and the second portion are arranged in a third direction different from each of the first direction and the second direction.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY CLAIM AND CROSS-REFERENCE (1) The present application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/115,571 filed on Dec. 8, 2020, which is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/525,311 filed on Jul. 29, 2019, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Typically, in the design of integrated circuits, standard cells having fixed functions are pre-designed. The pre-designed standard cells are stored in cell libraries. When designing integrated circuits, the standard cells are retrieved from the cell libraries and placed into desired locations on an integrated circuit layout. During the cell placement, the unit-row height layout system or the mixed-row heights system may be used. However, it is very challenging for the designer to balance the cell delay and the placement density of logic cells in the unit-row height layout system or the mixed-row heights system. Therefore, a novel architecture of logic cell for improving the cell placement problem in the layout system is highly desirable in the field of IC (Integrated circuit) design.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an electronic design automation system in accordance with some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 is a flowchart illustrating a method of designing and fabricating a semiconductor-based circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 is a diagram illustrating a cell library for storing logic cells in accordance with some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(6) FIG. 5A is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 5B is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with

some embodiments.

(8) FIG. 6A is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(9) FIG. 6B is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(10) FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(11) FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments.

(12) FIG. 9A is a diagram illustrating of a logic cell placed in a mixed-row heights layout system in accordance with some embodiments.

(13) FIG. 9B is a diagram illustrating of a logic cell placed in the mixed-row heights layout system in accordance with some embodiments.

(14) FIG. 9C is a diagram illustrating of a logic cell placed in the mixed-row heights layout system in accordance with some embodiments.

(15) FIG. 9D is a diagram illustrating a schematic circuit of a logic cell in accordance with some embodiments.

(16) FIG. 9E is a diagram illustrating a schematic circuit of a logic cell in accordance with some embodiments.

(17) FIG. 10 is a diagram illustrating a plurality of cell structures of a logic cell in accordance with some embodiments.

(18) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a placement method in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(19) The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the provided subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

(20) Further, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

(21) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an electronic design automation system **100** in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 1, system **100** includes an electronic design automation (“EDA”) tool **110** having a place and route tool including a chip assembly router **120**.

(22) The EDA tool **110** is a special purpose computer formed by retrieving stored program instructions **136** from a computer readable storage medium **130, 140** and executing the instructions on a general purpose processor **114**. Processor **114** may be any central processing unit (“CPU”), microprocessor, micro-controller, or computational device or circuit for executing instructions. The non-transitory machine readable storage medium **130, 140** may be a flash memory, random access memory (“RAM”), read only memory (“ROM”), or other storage medium. Examples of RAMs

include, but are not limited to, static RAM (“SRAM”) and dynamic RAM (“DRAM”). ROMs include, but are not limited to, programmable ROM (“PROM”), electrically programmable ROM (“EPROM”), and electrically erasable programmable ROM (“EEPROM”), to name a few possibilities.

(23) System **100** may include a display **116** and a user interface or input device **112** such as, for example, a mouse, a touch screen, a microphone, a trackball, a keyboard, or other device through which a user may input design and layout instructions to system **100**. The one or more computer readable storage mediums **130**, **140** may store data input by a user such as a circuit design and cell information **132**, which may include a cell library **132 a**, design rules **134**, one or more program files **136**, and one or more graphical data system (“GDS”) II files **142**.

(24) EDA tool **110** may also include a communication interface **118** allowing software and data to be transferred between EDA tool **110** and external devices. Examples of a communications interface **118** include, but are not limited to, a modem, an Ethernet card, a wireless network card, a Personal Computer Memory Card International Association (“PCMCIA”) slot and card, or the like. Software and data transferred via communications interface **118** may be in the form of signals, which may be electronic, electromagnetic, optical, or the like that are capable of being received by communications interface **118**. These signals may be provided to communications interface **118** via a communications path (e.g., a channel), which may be implemented using wire, cable, fiber optics, a telephone line, a cellular link, a radio frequency (“RF”) link and other communication channels. The communications interface **118** may be a wired link and/or a wireless link coupled to a local area network (LAN) or a wide area network (WAN).

(25) Router **120** is capable of receiving an identification of a plurality of cells to be included in a circuit layout, including a list **132** of pairs of cells, selected from the cell library **132 a**, within the plurality of cells to be connected to each other. Design rules **134** may be used for a variety of processing technologies. In some embodiments, the design rules **134** configure the router **120** to locate connecting lines and vias on a manufacturing grid. Other embodiments may allow the router to include off-grid connecting lines and/or vias in the layout.

(26) FIG. 2 illustrates one example of a method **200** of designing and fabricating a semiconductor-based circuit. In operation **202**, a gate-level netlist is developed or extracted. As will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, the gate-level netlist can be extracted from circuit schematic by processor **114** of system **100**.

(27) In operation **204**, floor planning for the semiconductor circuit is performed by system **100**. In some embodiments, floor planning includes dividing a circuit into functional blocks, which are portions of the circuit, and identifying the layout for these functional blocks.

(28) In operation **206**, power planning for the semiconductor circuit is performed by system **100**. Power planning includes identifying the power layout for the functional blocks of the semiconductor circuit. For example, the conductive traces for routing power and ground on the various conductive layers of the semiconductor circuit.

(29) In operation **208**, system **100** performs placement for the semiconductor circuit. According to some embodiments, the circuit placement includes determining the placement for the electronic components, circuitry, and logic elements. For example, the placement of the transistors, resistors, inductors, logic gates, and other elements of the semiconductor circuit are selected in operation **208**.

(30) In operation **210**, system **100** performs power-grid enhancement.

(31) In operation **212**, the routings for the devices and semiconductor circuit are mapped. Routing in operation **212** is performed by router **120** of system **100**.

(32) In operation **214**, a data file, such as a graphic database system (“GDS”) II file, including data representing the physical layout of the circuit is generated and stored in a non-transient machine readable storage **140**. As will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, the data file is used by mask making equipment, such as an optical pattern generator, to generate one or more masks for

the circuit.

(33) In operation **216**, one or more masks for the semiconductor circuit are created based on the data file stored in operation **214**. Once the physical design layout is generated, the physical design may be sent to a manufacturing tool to generate photolithographic masks that may be used for fabricating the semiconductor circuit. The physical design layout may be sent to the manufacturing tool through the LAN/WAN or other suitable forms of transmission from the EDA to the manufacturing tool.

(34) According to some embodiments, the operations **208-212** may be an APR (Automatic Place and Route) process. During the APR process, a layout of the semiconductor circuit (i.e. integrated circuit, IC) is generated automatically by the APR process by using the plurality of proposed standard cells or logic cells. A logic cell may represent a single functional block of logic. A standard cell for example may represent a NAND gate, NOR gate, flip flop, AND gate, OR gate, XOR gate, XNOR gate, inverter, latch, or the like. The logic cell enables an integrated circuit designer to utilize a library of cells as reusable building blocks for an integrated circuit without the need to separately design each block of logic represented by a cell. The logic cells may be included in a library of cells for use by integrated circuit designers.

(35) FIG. **3** is a diagram illustrating a cell library **302** for storing logic cells in accordance with some embodiments. The cell library **302** may be a standard cell library. The logic cells may be standard cells, and the logic cells may be applied into cell rows of a layout of a semiconductor circuit during the operations **208-212** or the APR process. A logic cell is arranged to perform a specific logical function. For example, the specific logical function may be the operation of NAND, NOR, flip flop, AND, OR, XOR, XNOR, inverting, latching, or the like. The logic cells may have different cell structures. According to some embodiments, the logic cells may be implemented with a plurality of cell structures **304**, **306**, **308**, **310**, **312**, and **314**. It is noted that the present disclosure is not limited by those cell structures. The logic cells may be configured to have other type of cell structures.

(36) According to some embodiments, the cell structure **304** may be a standard cell structure with a first cell height S . The cell structure **306** may be a second standard cell structure with a second cell height T . The cell height T is greater than the cell height S . The widths of the cell structure **304** and **306** are W_a and W_b respectively. According to some embodiments, the cell heights S and T may be constant heights and the widths W_a and W_b may be a variable width. However, this is not a limitation of the present disclosure. In another embodiment, the cell heights S and T may be variable heights and the widths W_a and W_b may be a constant width.

(37) The cell structure **308** may be a third standard cell structure having a first portion **308a** with the height S , a second portion **308b** with the height S , and a third portion **308c** with the height $T1$. The first portion **308a** and the second portion **308b** are separated by the third portion **308c**. According to some embodiments, the upper boundary (i.e. $B1$) of the third portion **308c** is abutted against a lower boundary of the first portion **308a**, and a lower boundary (i.e. $B2$) of the third portion **308c** is abutted against the upper boundary of the second portion **308b**. The width of the cell structure **308** is W_c . The height $T1$ is substantially equal to the height T of the standard cell structure **306**. The cell heights S and $T1$ may be constant heights and the width W_c may be a variable width. According to some embodiments, the first portion **308a**, the second portion **308b**, and the third portion **308c** may be formed within a bounding box **308d** of the cell structure **308**. The width of the bounding box **308d** is W_c , and the height of the bounding box **308d** is the total of the heights (i.e. $2*S+T1$) of the first portion **308a**, the second portion **308b**, and the third portion **308c**. The first portion **308a**, the second portion **308b**, and the third portion **308c** may be arranged to be a rectangular structure, and the rectangular structure may overlap with the bounding box **308d**. According to some embodiments, the first portion **308a** and the second portion **308b** may comprise semiconductor elements or active devices, e.g. transistors, and the third portion **308c** may comprise the interconnecting paths for coupling the semiconductor elements in the first portion

308a and the active devices in the second portion **308b**. The semiconductor elements may be the front-end-of-line (FEOL) in the semiconductor device, and the interconnecting paths may be the back-end-of-line (BEOL) in the semiconductor device.

(38) According to some embodiments, the height **T1** of the third portion **308c** may be greater than the height **T**. The height **T1** may be a total of $n \cdot T$ and $m \cdot S$, wherein n is an integer not less than 2, and m is an integer not less than 1. For example, the height **T1** may be a total of $2 \cdot T$ and $1 \cdot S$. In this example, the height **T1** is substantially equal to a total of the heights **T** of two standard cell structure **306** and the height of one standard cell structure **304**.

(39) The cell structure **310** may be a fourth standard cell structure having a first portion **310a** with the height **T**, a second portion **310b** with the height **T**, and a third portion **310c** with the height **S1**. The first portion **310a** and the second portion **310b** are separated by the third portion **310c**.

According to some embodiments, the upper boundary (i.e. **B3**) of the third portion **310c** is abutted against a lower boundary of the first portion **310a**, and a lower boundary (i.e. **B4**) of the third portion **310c** is abutted against the upper boundary of the second portion **310b**. The width of the cell structure **310** is **W_d**. The height **S1** is substantially equal to the height **S** of the standard cell structure **304**. The cell heights **T** and **S1** may be constant heights and the width **W_d** may be a variable width. According to some embodiments, the first portion **310a**, the second portion **310b**, and the third portion **310c** may be formed within a bounding box **310d** of the cell structure **310**. The width of the bounding box **310d** is **W_d**, and the height of the bounding box **310d** is the total of the heights (i.e. $2 \cdot T + S1$) of the first portion **310a**, the second portion **310b**, and the third portion **310c**. The first portion **310a**, the second portion **310b**, and the third portion **310c** may be arranged to be a rectangular structure, and the rectangular structure may overlap with the bounding box **310d**. According to some embodiments, the first portion **310a** and the second portion **310b** may comprise semiconductor elements, e.g. transistors, and the third portion **310c** may comprise the interconnecting paths for coupling the semiconductor elements in the first portion **310a** and the semiconductor elements in the second portion **310b**.

(40) According to some embodiments, the height **S1** of the third portion **310c** may be greater than the height **S**. The height **S1** may be a total of $n \cdot S$ and $m \cdot T$, wherein n is an integer not less than 2, and m is an integer not less than 1. For example, the height **S1** may be a total of $2 \cdot S$ and $1 \cdot T$. In this example, the height **S1** is substantially equal to a total of the heights **S** of two standard cell structure **304** and the height of one standard cell structure **306**.

(41) The cell structure **312**, which may be a rectilinear dual-driver cell structure, comprises a first portion **312a** with the height **S** and the width **W_e**, a second portion **312b** with the height **S** and the width **W_e**, and a third portion **312c**. The width **W_e** of the first portion **312a** may be different to the width **W_e** of the second portion **312b**. A distance between the first portion **312a** and the second portion **312b** in vertical direction is **T2**. A distance between the first portion **312a** and the second portion **312b** in horizontal direction is **D1**. The distance **T2** is substantially equal to the height **T** of the standard cell structure **306**. The heights **S** and **T2** may be constant heights and the widths **W_e** and **D1** may be variable widths. According to some embodiments, the first portion **312a**, the second portion **312b**, and the third portion **312c** may be formed within a bounding box **312d** of the cell structure **312**. The width of the bounding box **312d** is **W1**, and the height of the bounding box **312d** is **H1**. According to some embodiments, the width **W1** is not less than a total of the width **W_e** of the first portion **312a**, the width **W_e** of the second portion **312b**, and the distance **D1**. The height **H1** is not less than a total of the height **S** of the first portion **312a**, the height **S** of the second portion **312b**, and the distance **T2**. According to some embodiments, the bounding box **312d** has a rectangular boundary, and the first portion **312a** and the second portion **312b** may be located on the diagonal direction of the bounding box **312d**. However, this is not a limitation of the present embodiments. The bounding box **312d** may be a polygonal bounding box surrounding the first portion **312a**, the second portion **312b**, and the third portion **312c**. According to some embodiments, the first portion **312a** and the second portion **312b** may comprise

semiconductor elements, e.g. transistors, and the third portion **312c** may comprise the interconnecting paths for connecting the semiconductor elements in the first portion **312a** and the semiconductor elements in the second portion **312b**.

(42) According to some embodiments, the distance **T2** may be greater than the height **T**. The distance **T2** may be a total of $n \cdot T$ and $m \cdot S$, wherein n is an integer not less than 2, and m is an integer not less than 1. For example, the distance **T2** may be a total of $2 \cdot T$ and $1 \cdot S$. In this example, the distance **T2** is substantially equal to a total of the heights **T** of two standard cell structure **306** and the height of one standard cell structure **304**.

(43) The cell structure **314**, which may be a rectilinear dual-driver cell structure, comprises a first portion **314a** with the height **T** and the width W_f , a second portion **314b** with the height **T** and the width W_f , and a third portion **314c**. The width W_f of the first portion **314a** may be different to the width W_f of the second portion **314b**. A distance between the first portion **314a** and the second portion **314b** in vertical direction is **S2**. A distance between the first portion **314a** and the second portion **314b** in horizontal direction is **D2**. The distance **S2** is substantially equal to the height **S** of the standard cell structure **304**. The heights **T** and **S2** may be constant heights and the widths W_f and **D2** may be variable widths. According to some embodiments, the first portion **314a**, the second portion **314b**, and the third portion **314c** may be formed within a bounding box **314d** of the cell structure **314**. The width of the bounding box **314d** is **W2**, and the height of the bounding box **314d** is **H2**. According to some embodiments, the width **W2** is not less than a total of the width W_f of the first portion **314a**, the width W_f of the second portion **314b**, and the distance **D2**. The height **H2** is not less than a total of the height **T** of the first portion **314a**, the height **T** of the second portion **314b**, and the distance **S2**. According to some embodiments, the bounding box **314d** is a rectangular boundary, and the first portion **314a** and the second portion **314b** may be located on the diagonal direction of the bounding box **314d**. However, this is not a limitation of the present embodiments. The bounding box **314d** may be a polygonal bounding box surrounding the first portion **314a**, the second portion **314b**, and the third portion **314c**. According to some embodiments, the first portion **314a** and the second portion **314b** may comprise semiconductor elements, e.g. transistors, and the third portion **314c** may comprise the interconnecting paths for connecting the semiconductor elements in the first portion **314a** and the semiconductor elements in the second portion **314b**.

(44) According to some embodiments, the distance **S2** may be greater than the height **S**. The distance **S2** may be a total of $n \cdot S$ and $m \cdot T$, wherein n is an integer not less than 2, and m is an integer not less than 1. For example, the distance **S2** may be a total of $2 \cdot S$ and $1 \cdot T$. In this example, the distance **S2** is substantially equal to a total of the heights **S** of two standard cell structure **304** and the height of one standard cell structure **306**.

(45) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **400** of an integrated circuit (or a semiconductor device) in accordance with some embodiments. The layout system **400** may be a mixed-row heights layout system. The layout system **400** comprises a plurality of first-type doped rows **402a-402d** with a first row height, i.e. **S**, for each row and a plurality of second-type doped rows **404a-404d** with a second row height, i.e. **T**, for each row. The first-type doped rows **402a-402d** are arranged to be interleaved with the second-type doped rows **404a-404d**. For example, the upper edge (i.e. **E1**) of the first-type doped row **402a** abuts against the lower edge of the second-type doped row **404a**, the upper edge (i.e. **E2**) of the second-type doped row **404b** abuts against the lower edge of the first-type doped row **402a**, the upper edge (i.e. **E3**) of the first-type doped row **402b** abuts against the lower edge of the second-type doped row **404b**, and so on. Moreover, each of the first-type doped rows **402a-402d** may comprise n-type well(s) and/or p-type substrate(s), and each of the second-type doped rows **404a-404d** may comprise n-type well(s) and/or p-type substrate(s).

(46) As the row height **T** of the second-type doped rows **404a-404d** is greater than the row height **S** of the first-type doped rows **402a-404d**, the second-type doped rows **404a-404d** may be configured

to have relatively high speed transistors (or semiconductor elements), and the first-type doped rows **402a-402d** may be configured to have relatively low speed transistors.

(47) According to some embodiments, a logic cell **402** with the cell structure **304** may be placed on the first-type doped rows **402d**. A logic cell **404** with the cell structure **306** may be placed on the second-type doped rows **404c**.

(48) A logic cell **406** with the cell structure **308** may be placed on two first-type doped rows **402a**, **402b**, and one second-type doped row **404b**. The first-type doped rows **402a**, **402b**, and the second-type doped row **404b** may be three consecutive rows in the layout system **400**. Specifically, the first portion **308a** of the cell structure **308** may be disposed on the first-type doped row **402a**, the second portion **308b** of the cell structure **308** may be disposed on the other first-type doped row **402b**, and the third portion **308c** of the cell structure **308** may be disposed on the second-type doped row **404b**. The cell structure **308** may be regarded as a jump-row cell structure, i.e. the first portion **308a** and the second portion **308b** jump over or bridge over the second-type doped row **404b**. In the first-type doped rows **402a** and **402b**, the first portion **308a** and the second portion **308b** of the logic cell **406** are configured to have the relatively low transistors, and in the second-type doped row **404b**, the third portion **308c** of the logic cell **406** is configured to be the interconnecting paths between the relatively low transistors in the first portion **308a** and the second portion **308b**. According to some embodiments, the third portion **308c** is arranged to bridge over the second-type doped row **404b** or the logic cell placed in the second-type doped row **404b**.

(49) A logic cell **408** with the cell structure **310** may be placed on two second-type doped rows **404a**, **404b**, and one first-type doped row **402a**. The second-type doped rows **404a**, **404b**, and the first-type doped row **402a** may be three consecutive rows in the layout system **400**. Specifically, the first portion **310a** of the cell structure **310** may be disposed on the second-type doped row **404a**, the second portion **310b** of the cell structure **310** may be disposed on the other second-type doped row **404b**, and the third portion **310c** of the cell structure **310** may be disposed on the first-type doped row **402a**. The cell structure **310** may be regarded as a jump-row cell structure, i.e. the first portion **310a** and the second portion **310b** jump over or bridge over the first-type doped row **402a**. In the second-type doped rows **404a** and **404b**, the first portion **310a** and the second portion **310b** of the logic cell **408** are configured to have the relatively high transistors, and in the first-type doped row **402a**, the third portion **310c** of the logic cell **408** is configured to be the interconnecting paths between the relatively high transistors in the first portion **310a** and the second portion **310b**. According to some embodiments, the third portion **310c** is arranged to bridge over the first-type doped row **402a** or the logic cell placed in the first-type doped row **402a**.

(50) In addition, a logic cell **410** with a cell structure crossing a first-type doped row **402d** and a second-type doped row **404d** and a logic cell **412** with a cell structure crossing a first-type doped row **402c** and two second-type doped rows **404c** and **404d** may be placed on the layout system **400**. The detailed description of the logic cells **410** and **412** is omitted here for brevity.

(51) FIG. 5A is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **500a** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 5B is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **500b** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. In FIG. 5A, the layout system **500a** may be a mixed-row heights layout system. The layout system **500a** comprises a plurality of first-type doped rows **502a-502d** with the first row height S for each row and a plurality of second-type doped rows **504a-504d** with the second row height T for each row.

(52) According to some embodiments, a plurality of relatively low speed logic cells **506a-506e** may be placed on the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** respectively, and a plurality of relatively high speed logic cells **508a-508f** may be placed on the second-type doped rows **504a-504d** respectively. The number and the size of the logic cells **506a-506e** may be different from the number and the size of the logic cells **508a-508f**. Therefore, after the cell placement operation, the usage of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** and the second-type doped rows **504a-504d** may be unbalanced. For example, the usage rate of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** may be 30% while the usage

rate of the second-type doped rows **504a-504d** may be 70%. The unused spaces, e.g. **510a-510c**, in the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** are wasted but the area is still counted for the layout system **500a**. To increase the usage rate of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d**, the logic cells with the cell structure **308** may be placed in the spaces **510a-510c** of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** as shown in FIG. 5B.

(53) In comparison to the layout system **500a**, the layout system **500b** in FIG. 5B further comprises a logic cells **512** and **514**. The logic cell **512** is configured to be the cell structure **308**, and the logic cell **512** comprises a first portion **512a**, a second portion **512b**, and a third portion **512c**. The first portion **512a** is disposed in the space **510a** of the first-type doped row **502a**, the second portion **512b** is disposed in the space **510b** of the first-type doped row **502b**, and the third portion **512c** is disposed in the second-type doped row **504b** and is overlapped with a portion of the logic cell **508c**. According to some embodiments, the third portion **512c** is arranged to be the interconnecting paths of the first portion **512a** and the second portion **512b** and is formed in the BEOL of the semiconductor device, and the first portion **512a** and the second portion **512b** are arranged to be the semiconductor elements formed in the FEOL of the semiconductor device. Therefore, the third portion **512c** may be arranged to overlap with a portion of the logic cell **508c** viewing from the top of the semiconductor device.

(54) In addition, the logic cell **514** is also configured to be the cell structure **308** comprising a first portion **514a**, a second portion **514b**, and a third portion **514c**, wherein the first portion **514a** is disposed in the space **510b** of the first-type doped row **502b**, the second portion **514b** is disposed in the space **510c** of the first-type doped row **502c**, and the third portion **514c** is disposed in the second-type doped row **504c** and is overlapped with a portion of the logic cell **508e**. The third portion **514c** is arranged to be the interconnecting paths of the first portion **514a** and the second portion **514b** and is formed in the BEOL of the semiconductor device, and the first portion **514a** and the second portion **514b** are arranged to be the semiconductor elements formed in the FEOL of the semiconductor device. Therefore, the third portion **514c** may be arranged to overlap with a portion of the logic cell **508e** viewing from the top of the semiconductor device.

(55) Accordingly, the spaces **510a-510c** in the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** may be reused by the logic cells **512** and **514** with the cell structure **308** such that the usage rate of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** in the layout system **500b** may be increased. Moreover, when the active devices, e.g. transistors, in the first portion **512a** and the second portion **512b** of the logic cell **512** are placed in the same type of doped rows (i.e. the first-type doped rows **502a** and **502b**), the transistors in the first portion **512a** and the transistors in the second portion **512b** may have equal speed such that the signal delay of the logic cell **512** (as well as the circuit **514**) may be balanced and optimized.

(56) FIG. 6A is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **600a** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. 6B is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **600b** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. The layout system **600a** comprises a plurality of first-type doped rows **602a-602d** with the first row height S for each row and a plurality of second-type doped rows **604a-604d** with the second row height T for each row.

(57) According to some embodiments, a plurality of relatively low speed logic cells **606a-606e** may be placed on the first-type doped rows **602a-602d** respectively, and a plurality of relatively high speed logic cells **608a-608d** may be placed on the second-type doped rows **604a-604d** respectively. After the cell placement operation, the usage of the first-type doped rows **602a-602d** and the second-type doped rows **604a-604d** may be unbalanced. For example, the unused spaces, e.g. **610a-610b**, in the second-type doped rows **604a-604b** are wasted but the area is still counted for the layout system **600a**. To increase the usage rate of the second-type doped rows **604a-604d**, the logic cells with the cell structure **310** may be placed in the spaces **610a-610b** of the second-type doped rows **604a-604b** as shown in FIG. 6B.

(58) In comparison to the layout system **600a**, the layout system **600b** in FIG. 6B further comprises

a logic cell **612**. The logic cell **612** is configured to be the cell structure **310**, and the logic cell **612** comprises a first portion **612a**, a second portion **612b**, and a third portion **612c**. The first portion **612a** is disposed in the space **610a** of the second-type doped row **604a**, the second portion **612b** is disposed in the space **610b** of the second-type doped row **604b**, and the third portion **612c** is disposed in the first-type doped row **602a** and is overlapped with a portion of the logic cell **606a**. According to some embodiments, the third portion **612c** is arranged to be the interconnecting paths of the first portion **612a** and the second portion **612b** and is formed in the BEOL of the semiconductor device, and the logic cell **606a** and the second portion **612b** are arranged to be the semiconductor elements formed in the FEOL of the semiconductor device. Therefore, the third portion **612c** may be arranged to overlap with a portion of the logic cell **606a** viewing from the top of the semiconductor device.

(59) Accordingly, the spaces **610a-610b** in the second-type doped rows **604a-604b** may be reused by the logic cell **612** with the cell structure **310** such that the usage rate of the second-type doped rows **604a-604d** in the layout system **600b** may be increased. Moreover, when the active devices, e.g. transistors, in the first portion **612a** and the second portion **612b** of the logic cell **612** are placed in the same type of doped rows (i.e. the second-type doped rows **604a** and **604b**), the transistors in the first portion **612a** and the transistors in the second portion **612b** may have equal speed such that the signal delay of the logic cell **612** may be balanced and optimized.

(60) FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **700** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. For brevity, the numerals of elements in the layout system **700** are similar to the numerals of elements in the layout system **500b**.

(61) In comparison to the layout system **500b**, the layout system **700** in FIG. 7 further comprises a logic cell **702**. The logic cell **702** is configured to be the cell structure **312**, and the logic cell **702** comprises a first portion **702a**, a second portion **702b**, and a third portion **702c**. The first portion **702a** is disposed in the space **510d** of the first-type doped row **502c**, the second portion **702b** is disposed in the space **510f** of the first-type doped row **502d**, and the third portion **702c** is disposed in a portion of the second-type doped row **504c**, the first-type doped row **502c**, the second-type doped row **504d**, and the first-type doped row **502d**. The space **510d** and the space **510f** are rectilinear spaces. According to some embodiments, the third portion **702c** is arranged to be the interconnecting paths of the first portion **702a** and the second portion **702b** and is formed in the BEOL of the semiconductor device, and the logic cell **508e**, the logic cell **506c**, the logic cell **508f**, and the logic cell **506d** are arranged to be the semiconductor elements formed in the FEOL of the semiconductor device. Therefore, the third portion **702c** are formed above a portion of the logic cell **508e**, the logic cell **506c**, a portion of the logic cell **508f**, and the logic cell **506d**, and may be overlapped with the portion of the logic cell **508e**, the logic cell **506c**, the portion of the logic cell **508f**, and the logic cell **506d** viewing from the top of the semiconductor device.

(62) Accordingly, the spaces **510d-510f** in the first-type doped rows **502c-502d** may be reused by the logic cell **702** with the cell structure **312** such that the usage rate of the first-type doped rows **502a-502d** in the layout system **700** may be increased. Moreover, the resource of the layout system **700** may be increased by placing the rectilinear cell structures **312** into the rectilinear space fragments.

(63) FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating of a layout system **800** of an integrated circuit in accordance with some embodiments. For brevity, the numerals of elements in the layout system **800** are similar to the numerals of elements in the layout system **600a**.

(64) In comparison to the layout system **600a**, the layout system **800** in FIG. 8 further comprises a logic cell **802**. The logic cell **802** is configured to be the cell structure **314**, and the logic cell **802** comprises a first portion **802a**, a second portion **802b**, and a third portion **802c**. The first portion **802a** is disposed in the space **610a** of the second-type doped row **604a**, the second portion **802b** is disposed in the space **610c** of the second-type doped row **604b**, and the third portion **802c** is disposed in the second-type doped row **604a**, the first-type doped row **602a**, the second-type doped

row **604b**, and a portion of the first-type doped row **602b**. The space **610a** and the space **610c** are rectilinear spaces. According to some embodiments, the third portion **802c** is arranged to be the interconnecting paths of the first portion **802a** and the second portion **802b** and is formed in the BEOL of the semiconductor device, and the logic cell **608a**, the logic cell **606a**, the logic cell **608b**, and the logic cell **606b** are arranged to be the semiconductor elements formed in the FEOL of the semiconductor device. Therefore, the third portion **802c** are formed above a portion of the logic cell **608a**, a portion of the logic cell **606a**, the logic cell **608b**, and a portion of the logic cell **606b**, and may be overlapped with the portion of the logic cell **608a**, the portion of the logic cell **606a**, the logic cell **608b**, and the portion of the logic cell **606b** viewing from the top of the semiconductor device.

(65) Accordingly, the spaces **610a** and **610c** in the second-type doped rows **604a-604b** may be reused by the logic cell **802** with the cell structure **314** such that the usage rate of the second-type doped rows **604a-604d** in the layout system **800** may be increased. Moreover, the resource of the layout system **800** may be increased by placing the rectilinear cell structures **314** into the rectilinear space fragments.

(66) FIG. **9A** is a diagram illustrating of a logic cell **902** placed in a mixed-row heights layout system **900** in accordance with some embodiments. The logic cell **902** is configured to be the cell structure **306** and is placed on the second-type doped row **904** in the mixed-row heights layout system **900**. During the cell placement operation, the cell structure of the logic cell **902** may be replaced with a logic cell **910** with the cell structure **308** or a logic cell **912** with the cell structure **312** from the cell structure **306** to increase the usage of the first-type doped rows **906** and **908**. FIG. **9B** is a diagram illustrating of the logic cell **910** placed in the mixed-row heights layout system **900** in accordance with some embodiments. When the logic cell **902** is replaced with the logic cell **910**, the logic cell **902** may be re-configured into two portions, i.e. **910a** and **910b**. The two portions **910a** and **910b** may be placed in the first-type doped rows **906** and **908** respectively. The logic cell **910** is similar to the above mentioned logic cell **702**, thus the detailed description of the logic cell **910** is omitted here for brevity.

(67) FIG. **9C** is a diagram illustrating of the logic cell **912** placed in the mixed-row heights layout system **900** in accordance with some embodiments. When the logic cell **902** is replaced with the logic cell **912**, the logic cell **902** may be re-configured into two portions, i.e. **912a** and **912b**. The two portions **912a** and **912b** may be placed in the first-type doped rows **906** and **908** respectively. The logic cell **912** is similar to the above mentioned logic cell **512** or **514**, thus the detailed description of the logic cell **912** is omitted here for brevity.

(68) FIG. **9D** is a diagram illustrating a schematic circuit of the logic cell **902** in accordance with some embodiments. The schematic circuit of the logic cell **902** may comprise an AND gate (or NAND gate) having two input terminals **Ni1** and **Ni2** and an output terminal **No**. When the logic cell **902** is re-configured into the logic cell **910** or **912**, the schematic circuit of the logic cell **902** may be re-configured into the schematic circuit as shown in FIG. **9E**. FIG. **9E** is a diagram illustrating a schematic circuit of the logic cell **910** (or **912**) in accordance with some embodiments. The schematic circuit of the logic cell **910** comprises two AND gates **AND1** and **AND2**. In other words, the logic cell **902** is re-configured into dual-driver cells. The first input terminal of the AND gate **AND1** and the first input terminal of the AND gate **AND2** are coupled to the input terminal **Ni1**, the second input terminal of the AND gate **AND1** and the second input terminal of the AND gate **AND2** are coupled to the input terminal **Ni2**, and the output terminal of the AND gate **AND1** and the output terminal of the AND gate **AND2** are coupled to the output terminal **No**. The logical function of the logic cell **910** is similar to the logical function of the logic cell **902**. However, due to the dual-driver structure, the routing paths of the logic cell **910** may greater than the routing paths of the logic cell **902**. According to some embodiments, the first portion **910a** and the second portion **910b** may be the layout cell of the AND gate **AND1** and the AND gate **AND2** respectively. The third portion **910c** may be the layout portion of the interconnecting paths between the AND

gate AND1 and the AND gate AND2.

(69) FIG. 10 is a diagram illustrating a plurality of cell structures **1002a**, **1002b**, **1002c**, **1002d**, **1002e**, and **1002f** of a logic cell (e.g. a NAND gate) in accordance with some embodiments. The cell structures **1002a** may be the cell structure **304**. The cell structures **1002b** may be the cell structure **308**. The cell structures **1002c** may be the cell structure **306**. The cell structures **1002d** may be a cell structure having a first portion disposed in the first-type doped row and a second portion disposed in the second-type doped row. The cell structures **1002e** may be the cell structure **310**. The cell structures **1002f** may be the cell structure **314** (or **312**). According to some embodiments, the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002a** may have the largest signal delay, and the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002e** may have the smallest signal delay. In other words, the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002a** may have the lowest operating speed, and the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002e** may have the highest operating speed. The signal delay of the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002b** may be closed to the signal delay of the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002c**. The signal delay of the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002f** may be slightly smaller than the signal delay of the NAND gate with the cell structure **1002e**. For example, when the signal delays of the cell structures **1002a**, **1002b**, **1002c**, **1002d**, **1002e**, and **1002f** of the NAND gates are T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, and T6 respectively, the relationship of the signal delays T1, T2, T3, T4, T5, and T6 may be expressed as below:

$$T1 > T2 \approx T3 > T4 > T6 > T5$$

(70) In addition, for the NAND gates with the cell structures **1002b**, **1002e**, and **1002f**, the interconnecting paths or the post-connection wires used for connecting the different portions of the cell structure may cost additional area for the cell structure. For example, when the areas of the cell structures **1002a**, **1002b**, **1002c**, **1002d**, **1002e**, and **1002f** of the NAND gates are A1, A2, A3, A4, A5, and A6 respectively, the relationship of the areas A1, A2, A3, A4, A5, and A6 may be expressed as below:

$$A6 > A5 > A4 > A2 > A3 > A1$$

(71) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a placement method **1100** in accordance with some embodiments. The placement method **1100** may balance the placement density of a mixed-row heights layout system of an integrated circuit. The placement method **1100** comprises operations **1102-1108**. Provided that substantially the same result is achieved, the operations of the flowchart shown in FIG. 11 may not follow the same order and may not be contiguous. In some embodiments, other intermediate operations may be included.

(72) In operation **1102**, a plurality of cell circuits with a plurality of cell structures are placed in the mixed-row heights layout system (e.g. **500a**) having a plurality of first-type doped rows interleaved with a plurality of second-type doped rows. The plurality of cell structures may be the above mentioned cell structures **304**, **306**, **412**, and **1002d**.

(73) In operation **1104**, a measuring operation is performed upon the mixed-row heights layout system to determine if the density of the first-type doped rows is greater than the density of the second-type doped rows in the mixed-row heights layout system. If the density of the first-type doped rows is greater than the density of the second-type doped rows, goes to operation **1106**. If the density of the second-type doped rows is greater than the density of the first-type doped rows, goes to operation **1108**.

(74) In operation **1106**, a first adjusting operation is performed upon the mixed-row heights layout system. During the first adjusting operation, a number or a partial of the logic cells with the cell structure **304** are re-configured into the cell structure **306**, **310**, and/or **314**. For example, when the usage rate of the first-type doped rows is 80% and the usage rate of the second-type doped rows is 20%, the first adjusting operation may change 30% of the logic cells (e.g. the logic cells with the cell structure **304**) in the first-type doped rows into the second-type doped rows (e.g. the logic cells with the cell structures **306**, **310**, and/or **314**). After the first adjusting operation, the speed of the re-configured logic cells is increased, and the overall performance of the semiconductor device is

upgraded. The balancing of the usage of the first-type doped rows and the second-type doped rows is also improved.

(75) In operation **1108**, a second adjusting operation is performed upon the mixed-row heights layout system. During the second adjusting operation, a number or a partial of the logic cells with the cell structure **306** are re-configured into the cell structure **304**, **308**, and/or **312**. For example, when the usage rate of the second-type doped rows is 80% and the usage rate of the first-type doped rows is 20%, the second adjusting operation may change 30% of the logic cells (e.g. the logic cells with the cell structure **306**) in the second-type doped rows into the first-type doped rows (e.g. the logic cells with the cell structures **304**, **308**, and/or **312**).

(76) For another example, in operation **1108**, when the usage rate of the second-type doped rows is 80% and the usage rate of the first-type doped rows is 20%, the second adjusting operation may change 20% of the logic cells (e.g. the logic cells with the cell structure **306**) in the second-type doped rows into the logic cells with the cell structure **308**. After the second adjusting operation, the usage rate of the second-type doped rows is changed to 60% from 80% and the usage rate of the first-type doped rows is changed to 40% from 20%. Accordingly, the balancing of the usage of the first-type doped rows and the second-type doped rows is improved.

(77) Briefly, the proposed embodiment provides jump-row cell structures and rectilinear cell structures for the multi-height layout system to increase and to balance the usage density and the placement flexibility of the multi-height layout system. The resource of the multi-height layout system may be increased by placing the rectilinear cell structures into the rectilinear space fragments. Moreover, the jump-row logic cell structures may provide transistors with equal speed such that the signal delay of the cell may be balanced and optimized.

(78) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a logic cell structure embodied on a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The logic cell structure comprises a first portion, a second portion, and a third portion. The first portion is arranged to be a first layout of a first semiconductor element. The logic cell structure is formed on a substrate area. As viewed from a top of the substrate area, the first portion is placed in a first cell row of the substrate area, the first cell row extends in a first direction, and the first portion has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction. The second portion is arranged to be a second layout of a second semiconductor element. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, the second portion is placed in a second cell row of the substrate area and has the first height in the second direction, and the first portion is separated from the second portion. The third portion is arranged to be a third layout of an interconnecting path used for coupling the first semiconductor element and the second semiconductor element. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, the third portion is placed within the substrate area, and the first portion, the second portion, and the third portion are bounded by a bounding box with a height in the second direction and a width in the first direction. A center of the first portion and a center of the second portion are arranged in a third direction different from each of the first direction and the second direction.

(79) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides an integrated circuit. The integrated circuit comprises a substrate area, a first logic cell and a second logic cell. The substrate area comprises a plurality of first-type doped rows and a plurality of second-type doped rows. As viewed from a top of the substrate area, each of the first-type doped rows extends in a first direction, and has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction. The second-type doped rows are interleaved with the first-type doped rows. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the second-type doped rows extends in the first direction, and has a second height in the second direction. The first logic cell, formed on the substrate area, comprises a first portion, a second portion and a third portion. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, the first portion has the first height in the second direction and placed in one of the first-type doped rows, the second portion is placed in one of the second-type doped rows disposed at one side of the one of the first-type doped rows, and the third portion is placed in another of the second-type doped rows

disposed at another side of the one of the first-type doped rows. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, at least a portion of the second logic cell is placed in one of the one of the first-type rows and the one of the second-type doped rows.

(80) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides an integrated circuit. The integrated circuit comprises a substrate area and a logic cell. The substrate area comprises a plurality of first-type doped rows and a plurality of second-type doped rows. As viewed from a top of the substrate area, each of the first-type doped rows extends in a first direction, and has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction. The second-type doped rows are interleaved with the first-type doped rows. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the second-type doped rows extends in the first direction, and has a second height in the second direction. The logic cell, formed on the substrate area, comprises a first portion, a second portion and a third portion. As viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the first portion and the second portion has the first height in the second direction, the first portion is placed in one of the first-type doped rows, the second portion is placed in another of the first-type doped rows, and the third portion is overlapped with two of the second-type doped rows, disposed at opposite sides of the one of the first-type doped rows respectively.

(81) The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A logic cell structure embodied on a non-transitory computer-readable medium, the logic cell structure comprising: a first portion arranged to be a first layout of a first semiconductor element, the first semiconductor element being arranged to perform a first logical function, wherein the logic cell structure is formed on a substrate area; as viewed from a top of the substrate area, the first portion is placed in a first cell row of the substrate area, the first cell row extends in a first direction, and the first portion has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction; a second portion arranged to be a second layout of a second semiconductor element, the second semiconductor element being arranged to perform a second logical function identical to the first logical function, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, the second portion is placed in a second cell row of the substrate area and has the first height in the second direction; and a third portion, arranged to be a third layout of an interconnecting path used for coupling the first semiconductor element and the second semiconductor element, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, the third portion is placed within the substrate area, and the first portion placed in the first cell row and the second portion placed in the second cell row are separated by a third cell row located between and arranged in parallel to the first cell row and the second cell row, and are interconnected by a part of the third portion placed in the third cell row; the third portion has a second height in the second direction; a center of the first portion and a center of the second portion are arranged in a third direction different from each of the first direction and the second direction; the third portion is arranged to couple an input node of the first portion to an input node of the second portion, and couple an output node of the first portion to an output node of the second portion, wherein the second height is equal to the first height, and wherein the logic cell structure is stored in a standard cell library and is arranged to perform a specific function.

2. The logic cell structure of claim 1, wherein an operating speed of a transistor included in the first

semiconductor element formed according to the first portion is equal to an operating speed of a transistor included in the second semiconductor element formed according to the second portion.

3. The logic cell structure of claim 1, wherein the first portion and the second portion are located at opposite sides of the third portion in the second direction; the first portion, the second portion and the third portion are bounded by a bounding box with a height in the second direction and a width in the first direction; the height of the bounding box is equal to or greater than a total of the first height of the first portion, the first height of the second portion, and a distance between the first portion and the second portion in the second direction.

4. The logic cell structure of claim 1, wherein the first portion and the second portion are located at opposite sides of the third portion in the second direction; the first portion, the second portion and the third portion are bounded by a bounding box with a height in the second direction and a width in the first direction; the width of the bounding box is equal to or greater than a total of a first width of the first portion, a second width of the second portion, and a distance between the first portion and the second portion in the first direction.

5. An integrated circuit, comprising: a substrate area, comprising: a plurality of first-type doped rows, wherein as viewed from a top of the substrate area, each of the first-type doped rows extends in a first direction, and has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction; and a plurality of second-type doped rows, interleaved with the first-type doped rows, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the second-type doped rows extends in the first direction, and has a second height in the second direction; a first logic cell, formed on the substrate area, the first logic cell comprising: a first portion arranged to be a layout of a first semiconductor element; a second portion arranged to be a layout of a second semiconductor element; and a third portion arranged to be a layout of an interconnecting path formed in back-end-of-line (BEOL), the interconnecting path being used for coupling the first semiconductor element and the second semiconductor element, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, the first portion and the second portion are placed in two of the first-type doped rows respectively, the third portion is placed in one of the second-type doped rows, and the one of the second-type doped rows is disposed between the two of the first-type doped rows; and a second logic cell, having a first portion arranged to be a layout of a third semiconductor element formed in front-end-of-line (FEOL), the third portion of the first logic cell arranged to be formed in BEOL being at a level higher than the first portion of the second logic cell arranged to be formed in FEOL, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, the first portion of the second logic cell, arranged to be formed in FEOL, is placed in the one of the second-type doped rows, in which the third portion arranged to be formed in BEOL is placed, wherein the second height is equal to the first height, and wherein the first logic cell and the second logic cell are stored in a standard cell library and each of the first logic cell and the second logic cell is arranged to perform a specific function.

6. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein a second portion of the second logic cell is arranged to be a layout of an interconnecting path used for coupling the third semiconductor element to a fourth semiconductor element, and is placed in one of the first-type doped rows in which the second portion of the first logic cell is placed.

7. The integrated circuit of claim 6, wherein a third portion of the second logic cell is arranged to be a layout of the fourth semiconductor element, and is placed in another of the second-type doped rows.

8. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein a second portion of the second logic cell is arranged to be a layout of a fourth semiconductor element, and is placed in another of the second-type doped rows; one of the first-type doped rows in which the second portion of the first logic cell is placed is located between the one of the second-type doped rows and the another of the second-type doped rows.

9. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein the first semiconductor element is arranged to perform a first logical function, and the second semiconductor element is arranged to perform a second

logic function identical to the first logical function.

10. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein a second portion of the second logic cell is arranged to be a layout of an interconnecting path used for coupling the third semiconductor element to a fourth semiconductor element, and is placed in one of the first-type doped rows; the second portion of the second logic cell and the third portion of the first logic cell are located at opposite sides of the one of the second-type doped rows.

11. An integrated circuit, comprising: a substrate area, comprising: a plurality of first-type doped rows, wherein as viewed from a top of the substrate area, each of the first-type doped rows extends in a first direction, and has a first height in a second direction vertical to the first direction; and a plurality of second-type doped rows, interleaved with the first-type doped rows, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the second-type doped rows extends in the first direction, and has a second height in the second direction; and a logic cell, formed on the substrate area, the logic cell comprising: a first portion, a second portion and a third portion, wherein as viewed from the top of the substrate area, each of the first portion and the second portion has the first height in the second direction, the first portion is placed in one of the first-type doped rows, the second portion is placed in another of the first-type doped rows, the third portion is overlapped with the one of the first-type doped rows and one of the second-type doped rows, and the one of the first-type doped rows is disposed between the another of the first-type doped rows and the one of the second-type doped rows, wherein the logic cell structure is stored in a standard cell library and is arranged to perform a specific function.

12. The integrated circuit of claim 11, wherein the third portion is further overlapped with another of the second-type doped rows; the another of the second-type doped rows is disposed between the one of the first-type doped rows and the another of the first-type doped rows.

13. The integrated circuit of claim 11, wherein the third portion is further overlapped with the another of the first-type doped rows.

14. The integrated circuit of claim 11, wherein a center of the first portion and a center of the second portion are arranged in a third direction different from each of the first direction and the second direction.

15. The integrated circuit of claim 11, wherein the second height is different from the first height.

16. The integrated circuit of claim 11, wherein the second height is equal to the first height.

17. The integrated circuit of claim 1, wherein the first semiconductor element and the second semiconductor element are formed in front-end-of-line (FEOL).

18. The integrated circuit of claim 1, wherein an upper boundary of the third portion is abutted against a lower boundary of the first portion, and a lower boundary of the third portion is abutted against an upper boundary of the second portion.

19. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein an operating speed of a transistor included in the first semiconductor element formed according to the first portion is equal to an operating speed of a transistor included in the second semiconductor element formed according to the second portion.

20. The integrated circuit of claim 5, wherein the first portion, the second portion, and the third portion of the first logic cell are arranged to be a same width.
